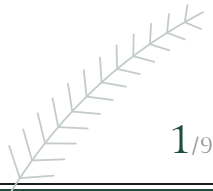


# This Christmas.



THE SHAPE OF IT

Christmas Day at

Who is there

Adults Children

Staying over

Travelling on

Christmas Eve is

Boxing Day is

MONEY, DECIDED NOW — A number written down is spent slower

Gifts Food & drink

Travel Everything else

All of it, and not a penny more

WHO DOES WHAT — Christmas is not one person's job

THE JOB WHOSE

Presents

Food shopping

Cooking on the day

Cards and post

Washing up

What we are not doing this year

Fill this in before anything else. Christmas gets heavy because everything from every previous year is still on the list. Name three things you are dropping — a card to everyone, a second pudding, the drive on the day — and the rest of this kit gets easier.

THE ONE THING THAT HAS TO BE RIGHT

BOOKED, ORDERED, PAID FOR — Anything with a date on it

TRADITIONS WORTH KEEPING

# December, day by day.

THE TWENTY-FIVE

Most days should stay empty

1

☐

2

☐

3

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4

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24

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25

☐

DATES THAT ARE NOT YOURS TO MOVE

Look them up once

Last post, second class

Last post, first class

Last post, overseas

Food order placed

Food order collected

School / work ends

Tree up

Guests arrive

The posting dates are the real deadline

Cards and parcels are the one part of Christmas that cannot be done late. Find this year's last posting dates in the first week of December, write them above, and work back from them – not from the twenty-fifth.

ORDERED, NOT BOUGHT

Turkey, ham, a cake, a case of wine

☐

☐

☐

☐

☐

NOBODY HAS CLAIMED THESE YET

December, written down.

...

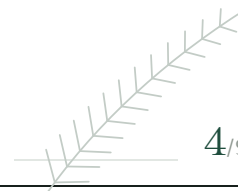
3/9



Fill the budget column first, before you buy anything

December, written down.

4/9



Overseas first – they leave weeks earlier

WRIT POST

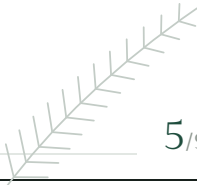
[illegible]

GONE

[illegible]

- ☐ A pen that does not smudge

# What we are eating.

Date  5/9

**THE MEAL** \_\_\_\_\_ Who makes it, not just what it is

| DISH | WHO | GOT |
|------|-----|-----|
|------|-----|-----|

|       |       |                          |
|-------|-------|--------------------------|
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
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| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |

**PUDDING, CHEESE, CHOCOLATE** \_\_\_\_\_

|       |       |                          |
|-------|-------|--------------------------|
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |

- THE BITS NOBODY REMEMBERS** \_\_\_\_\_
- ☐ Bread, butter, gravy, sauces
  - ☐ Milk and cream – twice what you think
  - ☐ Foil, cling film, freezer bags for the leftovers
  - ☐ A proper meal for whoever eats no meat

**DRINK** \_\_\_\_\_ Count the non-drinkers too

|       |       |                          |
|-------|-------|--------------------------|
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |

**WHO CANNOT EAT WHAT** \_\_\_\_\_ Ask now, not on the day

|       |       |                          |
|-------|-------|--------------------------|
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |

**BUY EARLY, IT KEEPS** \_\_\_\_\_

|                          |       |
|--------------------------|-------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> | _____ |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | _____ |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | _____ |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | _____ |

**BUY ON THE LAST DAY, IT WILL NOT** \_\_\_\_\_

|                          |       |
|--------------------------|-------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> | _____ |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | _____ |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | _____ |



# The house, and the beds.

Date  7/9

ROOM BY ROOM One idea each is plenty

| WHERE       | WHAT GOES THERE | DONE                     |
|-------------|-----------------|--------------------------|
| Tree        |                 | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Front door  |                 | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Hall        |                 | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Living room |                 | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Table       |                 | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Kitchen     |                 | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Spare room  |                 | <input type="checkbox"/> |

THE TREE

Bought on  Up on

- ☐ Lights tested before they go on
- ☐ Water it – a real tree drinks daily
- ☐ Nothing breakable at toddler or dog height

THE THINGS THAT GO MISSING EVERY YEAR

- ☐ The stockings
- ☐ Spare bulbs and fuses for the lights
- ☐ The good tablecloth and the napkins
- ☐ Crackers, and somewhere to hide them
- ☐ The tree stand

WHO IS SLEEPING WHERE

| WHO | WHERE | BED                      | TWL                      |
|-----|-------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
|     |       | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
|     |       | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
|     |       | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
|     |       | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
|     |       | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |

THINGS GUESTS ALWAYS NEED AND NEVER BRING

- ☐ A spare toothbrush and toothpaste
- ☐ A phone charger by the bed
- ☐ An extra blanket, and where the heating is
- ☐ Somewhere to put a suitcase down

WHERE THE BOXES LIVE Thank yourself in January

DONE BEFORE THE DOORBELL

- ☐
- ☐
- ☐

8/9



Only the things that need a time

## WHO IS ON IT

Write the time next to each

- 1 **Awake, and the first cup of tea**  
Before the first present, not after
- 2 **Presents**  
Slower than anyone wants; someone collects the paper
- 3 **Breakfast that is not the lunch**  
Otherwise nobody eats until four
- 4 **Kitchen closes to visitors**  
One cook, one helper, everyone else out
- 5 **Lunch**  
The time from page 6, said out loud the night before
- 6 **The walk, or the quiet hour**  
The part people remember
- 7 **Calls to whoever is not here**  
Put a time on it or it slips
- 8 **Games, film, leftovers**  
Nothing more is cooked today

# The week after.

Date  9/9

**RETURNS** ————— Most shops give until mid-January — but check

| WHAT | FROM | BY WHEN | DONE |
|------|------|---------|------|
|------|------|---------|------|

|       |       |       |                          |
|-------|-------|-------|--------------------------|
| _____ | _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |

**THANK-YOUS OWED** ————— Let the children write their own

| TO | FOR | SENT |
|----|-----|------|
|----|-----|------|

|       |       |                          |
|-------|-------|--------------------------|
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
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| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |

**Buy next year's Christmas this week**

Cards, paper, crackers, lights and decorations are half price from the twenty-seventh. Buy them now, put them in one labelled box with the decorations, and write on the lid what is inside. It is the cheapest hour you will spend on next Christmas.

**BOUGHT IN THE SALES, IN THE BOX** —————

|                          |       |
|--------------------------|-------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> | _____ |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | _____ |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | _____ |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | _____ |

**WHAT WE SPENT, HONESTLY** —————

Planned \_\_\_\_\_ Actual \_\_\_\_\_

**KEEP, CHANGE, DROP** ————— Before you forget

|       |
|-------|
| _____ |
| _____ |
| _____ |